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11:05 AM

Welcome to Stream A!

Heather

Kick-off and housekeeping.

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TODAY'S SCHEDULE

Stream A — What's on

TIME	TOPIC	DESCRIPTION
11:05 AM	Welcome to Stream A!	Kick-off and housekeeping
11:15 AM	Quick Wins with Claude	Practical wins and example of using Claude
11:35 AM	Don't Be Afraid To Build	Data techniques for staying safe so you can build
12:20 PM	Let's Talk Terminology	Common AI terms and what they mean
12:40 PM	Lunch	Lunch then return for 1:30 PM
1:30 PM	Let's Build	Putting it all together – Build Framework and Live Build
2:30 PM	Wrap Up & Q&A	AMA (Ask Me Anything) for all presenters
3:00 PM	Afternoon Tea	Return for 3:15 PM
3:15 PM	Hack Session	Build something real

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Nat

Beau

Heather

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11:15 AM

Quick Wins with Claude

Heather · Beau · Nat

Practical wins and examples of using Claude.

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Don't Be Afraid

Building with AI without giving up your data.

SESSION A2 · BEAU GAUDRON

INTRODUCTION

The concern we hear every week

“I want to use AI…

…but I don't know where to start.”

“I want to use AI…

…but I'm worried about sharing client data.”

In this session: techniques for building with AI — without giving up your data.

STEP ONE · GET MOVING WITHOUT REAL DATA

Dummy data to start

You already have an idea. Data is the blocker. Start with data that isn't yours.

01

Building with Xero?

Sign up for a Xero trial, use the API Explorer on demo-company data. Zero risk.

02

Building with something else?

Ask: what's available (APIs, MCPs, connectors) and what are the access limits?

03

Generating fake data at scale

If you know how the data should look, let an LLM fabricate it. Test the whole build first.

Dummy data proves the build. But you want real data — and real action.

A QUICK INTERLUDE

Principle of Least Privilege

Sounds complex
...but you already do this.

When you grant someone access to an accounting system, you don't hand them everything. You decide what they need to see.

THE PRINCIPLE

Only give up enough for the task at hand

THE CORE IDEA

What is data obfuscation?

Adjusting real data while keeping it non-identifiable.

You have a client name. You swap it for a unique randomised token. The AI still analyses the shape of your data it just doesn't know who.

Result: minimised risk of data exposure.

BEFORE

Acme Pty Ltd
Jane Smith
ABN 12 345 678 901

AFTER

CLIENT_001
CONTACT_A
ABN 99 111 222 333

SIDE NOTE

Always ask: what data is this?

PUBLIC DATA

A dashboard of your social channels? The data is already out there. Worry less about what you share with the model.

STILL GUARD THIS

API keys. Access tokens. Credentials. Client Identifiers.

HOW TO OBFUSCATE

A lookup table is the whole trick

REAL VALUE	TOKEN
Acme Pty Ltd	CLIENT_001
Northwind Ltd	CLIENT_002
Jane Smith	CONTACT_A
John Doe	CONTACT_B

Real value one side. Token the other. Swap one way to send data out swap the other way to bring answers back.

The table IS the key.

Keep it in a file you control. The AI never sees the real data.

EVERYONE CAN DO THIS TODAY

Level 1 — Excel formulas

1 Build a two-column lookup and swap with XLOOKUP.

1. Build a two-column table: real name + token (CLIENT_001, CLIENT_002…)
2. Use =UNIQUE() and =SEQUENCE() to auto-generate the token list
3. =XLOOKUP to swap real values → tokens before sending to AI
4. =XLOOKUP in reverse to restore real values in the AI's response

PROS

No new tools. Works in modern Excel. Easy to explain.

CONS

Manual steps. Easy to forget a column.

POWER QUERY OR OFFICE SCRIPTS

Level 2 — one-click workflow

2

Record a macro, attach a button, refresh on demand.

Power Query

Use Merge queries to swap tokens in and out. Right-click, Refresh.

Office Scripts

Record a macro that does the swap and attach it to a button. Works on Windows, Mac, and web.

PROS Repeatable. Self-service for the team.

CONS Needs M365 business licence; a bit of setup.

Level 3 — Python or a small script

3 Format-preserving encryption. Nothing leaves the machine in cleartext.

pyffx	Format-preserving encryption — an ABN stays an 11-digit number.
HMAC hash	A simple, deterministic token for one-way tokenisation.
Key storage	Keep the encryption key in a password manager or secret store.

```
from pyffx import String

cipher = String(
  key, alphabet="ABC...", length=11
)
cipher.encrypt(abn)
```

PROS: stronger guarantees. CONS: not easily transferrable to other systems without additional work

THE PRINCIPLE IS THE SAME AT EVERY LEVEL

“The model never sees the real data. You hold the key.”

Pick the level that matches your team's comfort.

HANDS ON

Exercise — try it yourself

Download a dummy dataset from GitHub. No real client data — just Karbon & FYI shaped JSON.

01

`karbon_example.csv`

Upload to Claude: “Give me a breakdown of where each team member works based on this file.”

02

`fyi_example.csv`

For this one: Create a 1000 records but add the categories, Tax, Bookkeeping and FBT

INTERCONNECTIVITY

“I can already do this in Excel”

Sure. But think beyond the spreadsheet.

1

Scheduled

An agent produces the summary on a schedule nightly, weekly, whenever.

2

Distributed

Automatically routed to Slack or email for each manager or team member.

3

Actionable

Managers get time visibility without having to ask. Insight becomes operations.

It all starts with data. The question is: how do we get it, and what do we do with it?

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12:20 PM

Let's Talk Terminology

Heather · Beau · Nat

Common AI terms and what they mean

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12:40 PM

Lunch

Break for lunch — return for 1:30 PM.

BREAK · STREAM A

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1:30 PM

Let's Build

Heather · Beau · Nat

Putting it all together — live build.

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PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

A framework for your build

01

Plan

Use your domain knowledge to scope the task: blockers, manual steps, data, tech, users, expected output. Don't reinvent the wheel ROAD: Rip Off And Duplicate (and improve!)

02

Define

Give the AI clear, detailed instructions. Two paths: a detailed prompt, OR a CLAUDE.MD / AGENTS.MD instructions file you can carry between tools.

03

Build (Test)

Aim for an MVP make it work, even if ugly. Treat AI as a tool, not a wizard. Test functionality first, then usability. Track issues in an issues file.

04

Refine

Now make it better. Tackle the little things you let slide in the test phase: branding, polish, edge cases, the rough corners that almost-but-not-quite worked.

05

Repeat / Share

Turn your creation into a reusable Skill, then share it with your team so the work compounds.

Plan → Define → Build → Refine → Share

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2:30 PM

Wrap Up & Q&A

Heather · Beau · Nat

AMA for all presenters.

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3:00 PM

Afternoon Tea

Return for 3:15 PM.

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3:15 PM

Hack Session

Audience activity

Build something real.

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Don't keep this *to yourself*

You've just upskilled in AI. That's worth sharing.

Try this post:

> **I've just completed AI Build Day. Practical, hands-on, and already changing how I work.**

Tag the event. Start a conversation.

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Thank you!